

Subject Code	ENGL4017
Subject Title	Critical Language and Cultural Studies
Credit Value	3
Level	4
Pre-requisite / Co-requisite/ Exclusion	None
Objectives	The subject introduces students to the critical analysis of discourse. In the course students identify and analyse the core cultural meanings in contemporary social life through the linguistic resources found in a range of both offline and online texts. It enables students to reflect, and critically appreciate the meanings constructed through a range of genres. In this subject, students examine, analyse and discuss a range of genres including educational, political, workplace, and media texts in both offline and online settings. Discourse will be analysed in order to understand the cultural assumptions embedded within the text. As stated by Fairclough (1992, p. 7), this subject will investigate: <i>How language conventions and language practices are invested with power relations and processes which people are often unaware of. It criticizes mainstream language study for taking conventions and practices at face value as objects to be described, in a way which obscures their political ideological investment.</i> The skills and knowledge gained by the students will be applicable to other subjects and areas studied and to students' future professions and will also enable them to be responsible global citizens.
Intended Learning Outcomes	Upon completion of the subject, students will be able to: Category A: Professional/academic knowledge and skills - display the necessary critical analytical skills to undertake a robust analysis of authentic online and offline discourse, both spoken and written, derived primarily from professional settings. - critically reflect on, discuss and understand the explicit and implicit socio-cultural meanings in a range of texts. - integrate and synthesise ideas and approaches studied. - reflect, generalize, summarise and present the analysis they undertake. Category B: Attributes for all-roundedness

	The subject is assessed entirely through coursework. Students are assessed in terms of both subject knowledge and practical application. Each assignment requires the critical application of a discourse analysis approach/concept to authentic professional and public discourse(s). Students are expected to evaluate both the method(s) and their findings and/or meaningfully synthesise their ideas.
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Student Study Effort Expected	Class contact:	
	▪ Lectures	39 Hrs.
	▪ Seminars	0 Hrs.
	Other student study effort:	
	▪ Private study	58 Hrs.
	▪ Take-home assignments	29 Hrs.
	Total student study effort	126 Hrs.

Reading List and References	Bhatia, A. (2015). <i>Discursive illusions in public discourse: Theory and practice</i>. Routledge. Bhatia, V. K. (2017). <i>Critical genre analysis: Investigating interdiscursive performance in professional practice</i>. Routledge. Blommaert, J. (2005). <i>Discourse: Key topics in sociolinguistics</i>. Cambridge University Press. Charteris-Black, J. (2004). <i>Corpus approaches to critical metaphor analysis</i>. Palgrave Macmillan. Fairclough, N. (2013). <i>Critical discourse analysis: The critical study of language</i>. Routledge. Jaworski, A. & Coupland, N. (2014). <i>The Discourse Reader</i>. Routledge. Machin, M., & Mayr, A. (2015). <i>How to do critical discourse analysis: A multimodal introduction</i>. Sage. Van Dijk, T.A. (1993). Principles in critical discourse analysis. <i>Discourse & Society</i>, 4(2), 249–283. Wodak, R., & Meyer, M. (Eds.). (2015). <i>Methods of critical discourse studies</i>. Sage. Useful Journals <i>Journal of Pragmatics</i> <i>Discourse & Communication</i> <i>Discourse & Society</i> <i>Critical Discourse Studies</i>
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Revised by Rickey Lu, December 2024